



Architects Registration Board

Hong Kong Special Administrative Region

建築師註冊管理局

香港特別行政區

Code of Professional Conduct

Introduction

Under the Architects Registration Ordinance (“ARO”) section 9, the Architects Registration Board, Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (“ARB” or the “Board”) may make rules for the conduct and discipline of a registered architect (“RA”).

This ARB Code of Professional Conduct (“ARB CoPC”) is established by the Board

- 1) to serve as “mandatory” rules for regulating and disciplining of an RA; and
- 2) to set out those behaviour for which an RA risks being disciplined under the ARO, including suspension or revocation of the privilege to practice, by ARB.

The ARB CoPC are organized under 5 key aspects,

- 1) Competence
- 2) Integrity
- 3) Managing Conflict of Interest
- 4) Statutory and Regulatory Compliance
- 5) Regard for Public Interest

ARB reckons that the above are the essential qualities expected of an RA as a trustworthy professional.

While an architect is obliged to serve his/her client’s best interest, an RA is also deemed to have a supervening duty to safeguard the safety and the well-being of the public.

ARB Code of Professional Conduct

1	Competence	A Registered Architect shall diligently carry out the duties he/she undertakes under the Client / Architect Agreement to the best of his/her ability, up to the professional standards expected of a member of the profession.
2	Integrity	A Registered Architect shall act impartially at all times and shall administer all building contracts and/or consultancy agreements under his/her control with fairness and integrity. A Registered Architect shall at all times, whether in the course of business or not, conduct himself/herself with honesty, integrity and propriety to be expected of a member of an honourable profession. A Registered Architect shall make known his/her updated personal and professional status to any persons/parties who are expected to be affected by the services he/she proffers in the capacity of an architect, once - he/she becomes an undischarged bankrupt, or - he/she has his/her application for renewal, or registration rejected by the Architects Registration Board. A Registered Architect shall promote his/her abilities and/or services for business advancement honestly & responsibly. A Registered Architect shall not maliciously criticize the work of another architect. A Registered Architect shall not direct and/or make undue influence on any other architect to act in any manner which could violate the Code of Professional Conduct of the Architects Registration Board.
3	Managing Conflict of Interest	A Registered Architect shall not have any interest, financial or personal, in connection with any business which may be inconsistent or in conflict with his/her professional obligations, unless such interest or connection is fully declared to all parties likely to be affected by such interest.
4	Statutory and Regulatory Compliance	A Registered Architect shall not at all times, whether in the course of business or not, act in any unlawful or unethical manner which is liable to bring the profession of architecture in Hong Kong into disrepute. A Registered Architect shall co-operate with the Architects Registration Board on its disciplinary investigation, either as a respondent or witness, with full disclosure of facts to the best of his/her knowledge.
5	Regard for Public Interest	A Registered Architect shall have a proper regard for the safety and well-being of all those who may be expected to use or enjoy the result of his/her efforts.

Architects Registration Board

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